

329 Force buds to open

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MINS

When trees start to show buds after a long winter, you know that spring is finally on its way. Encourage buds to break into leaf a bit sooner by bringing some twigs indoors. Try forsythia, horse chestnut, willow, or birch twigs.

What you need

- Twigs • Jar
- Pruning shears
- Water



1 Ask an adult to help you cut some twigs with the pruning shears. Always ask permission first and don't take too much.

2 Make sure the bottoms of the twigs are cut at a slant and place them in a jar of water.

3 Keep the jar in a sunny spot and wait for the buds to open. This could take a few weeks.

Buds begin to break out

Slanted cuts help stems take up water

New leaves

330 Look for catkins

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Many spring-flowering trees produce their flowers in the form of catkins, which appear before the leaves. Take a walk to look for catkins on hazel, birch, willow, or alder trees.

Alder catkins

